

SYLLABUS FOR ARTS - J121

CHRISTIAN RELIGIOUS STUDIES

GENERAL OBJECTIVES

At the end of the study of the course, candidates should be able to:

1. explain how the Old and the New Testaments came into existence;
2. enumerate the outstanding Kings and Prophets of Israel during the monarchy and itemize the contributions of each to the religious, social and political development of Israel;
3. trace the history and development of Christianity in West Africa with particular reference to Sierra Leone, Ghana and Nigeria;
4. discuss the relationship between religion and society paying attention to such personality and human values like dignity, security, power and prestige based on basic rights and duties and religious sanctions; and
5. highlight Christian response to specific contemporary societal challenges, stressing effects of such on the individual and the society and proffer the way forward.

FIRST SEMESTER

CRS 001: OLD TESTAMENT STUDIES: HISTORY AND RELIGION OF ISRAEL **(3 Units)**

CRS 002: NEW TESTAMENT STUDIES: THE GOSPELS **(3 Units)**

SECOND SEMESTER

CRS 003: HISTORY OF CHRISTIANITY IN WEST AFRICA **(3 Units)**

CRS 004: RELIGION AND SOCIETY **(3 Units)**

COURSE DESCRIPTION

CRS 001: OLD TESTAMENT STUDIES: HISTORY AND RELIGION OF ISRAEL

Specific Objectives

At the end of the study of this course, candidates should be able to:

1. explain the term 'inspiration' and analyze the process of canonization of the Old Testament;
2. highlight the genre of Old Testament literature and discuss the issues involved in the documentary hypotheses;
3. evaluate how the nation of Israel started, examine the factors that gave birth to the monarchy in Israel and mention the roles of notable Kings (Saul, David and Solomon) to the religious and socio-political development of the land;
4. give a detailed description of the events that led to the Divided Kingdom; and

5. appraise prophecy in Israel and the influence of Prophets Isaiah, Hosea and Amos; the relevance of the themes to nation building (particularly in Nigeria) should be pointed out.

Course Content

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
1.	Formation and Composition of the Old Testament	Inspiration	i) Biblical inspiration Explain the term ‘Inspiration’ as it applies to the composition of the Old Testament ii) Inspirational Theories Discuss the theories such as Dictation Theory, Verbal Plenary, Dynamic or Content Theory, Neo-Orthodox Theory, and Limited Theory
		Canonization	i) The meaning of the term ‘Canon’. ii) process of the canonization of the Old Testament iii) Explain the different applications of canon with reference to the Old Testament iv) the criteria for Old Testament canonization. v) Identification and categorization of canonical books: <i>Torah</i> (Law), <i>Nebiim</i> (Prophets), and <i>Ketubiim</i> (Writings).
		Genre of Literature	i) Explain the term ‘genre’. ii) List out the different types of literature in the Old Testament: Historical, Poetic, Wisdom, and prophetic literature
2.	Israel’s Nationhood	God’s Call of Abraham	Process of God’s call of Abraham (Gen.12:1-7)
		Call of Moses	Moses’ encounter of God in the wilderness (Exodus 3:1-18, 20:1-20)
3	Mosaic Authorship of the Pentateuch: An Overview	Proofs of Mosaic Authorship	i) Discuss the arguments for Mosaic authorship. ii) Instances for Mosaic authorship: Internal and External evidences.
		Arguments Against Mosaic Authorship	i) Discuss the arguments against Mosaic authorship. ii) Mention instances against Mosaic authorship: Internal and External evidences
		The Documentary Hypotheses	i) Examine the nature and types of the Documentary Hypotheses to include Early Documentary Hypothesis, Fragmentary Hypothesis and Supplementary Hypothesis ii) The J. E. D. P. documents. iii) the characteristics of J. E. D. P. documents.

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
4	The Rise of Monarchy in Israel	Historical Settings for the Establishment of the Monarchy (1 Sam. 1 - 7)	i) Identify the factors that gave rise to the Monarchy. ii) Discuss the roles of Eli and Samuel in the institution of monarchy in Israel.
		The Establishment of the Monarchy (1 Sam. 8-12)	i) The ministry of Eli and the birth of Samuel. ii) The call of Samuel. The role of Eli and Samuel in the constitution of Monarchy in Israel iii) The war with the Philistines and the capture of the Ark of God. iv) The role of Samuel as Priest, Judge and Prophet prior to the monarchy in Israel.
		Factors that led to the request for a king	i) Fear of the Philistine, corruption of Samuel's sons, influence of other nations, Samuel's old age, and the need for a united living. ii) How Samuel anointed Saul as king. iii) the inauguration of Saul as king at Gilgal.
		Saul's Reign and Failures (1 Sam. 13-15)	i) Highlight the successes of the reign of King Saul: built the army, formed Israel's enemy, captured lost land, setting up a monarchical structure, etc. ii) Examine the factors that caused the fall of King Saul: disobedience, envy, impatient, pride, men pleaser, divination (necromancy), influence of evil spirit, etc.
		David's Reign over Israel (1Sam. 16 - 2Sam. 24)	i) The anointing of David as king ii) The achievement of King David: United the kingdom, wrote Psalm, organised worship, won battles, provided materials for the building of the Temple, killed Goliath, defended the nation, expanded Israel's territory, etc. iii) the weaknesses of David: adultery, inability to control his children; murder; family crises; etc.
		The Reign of King Solomon (1 Kg. 1:11-31)	i) Solomon's ascension to the throne. ii) Appraise his reign and state his contributions to Israel e.g. his building projects, iii) Explain the folly of King Solomon: forced labour, mixed marriages, many women that drew his heart away from Yahweh, idolatry etc.

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
5	The Divided Kingdoms and the Exiles	Factors that Led to the Division of the Kingdom (1Kg. 12:1-25)	i) Explain the factors that led to the division of the Kingdom such as David economic policy, spill over of King Solomon's bad rule; unwise decision of King Rehoboam; the prophecy of Ahijah, age-long conflict among the tribes of Israel, etc. ii) Reign and activities of King Rehoboam of Judah and Jeroboam of Israel
		The Exiles: An Overview (2Kg. 16 – 25).	i) Mention the causes and effects of the exiles. (2Kg.17:1-28, 24) ii) State of the exiles (2 Kg 25)
7	The Rise of Prophecy in Israel.	Early Manifestations of Prophecy in Israel	i) Identify the rise of the Pre-Canonical Prophets in the development of Israel such as Moses, Joshua, Samuel (Jos. 23:1-13,) ii) Examine the characteristics of prophecies: Inspiration, repentance, dedication to God, fearless, etc. iii) the role of the prophets: pious worship; school of prophets; etc.
		The Major and Minor Prophets: Themes from Isaiah, Amos and Hosea	i) Distinguish between the major and the minor prophets. ii) Examine Prophet Isaiah's message on holiness and discuss its relevance to nation building. (Isa. 1 – 6). iii) Explain Hosea's message on love and its implications for Israel (Hos. 1 – 3). iv) Explain the message of Amos on justice and discuss its relevance to nation building (Amos 1 – 5). v) Relevance of these messages to nation building (i.e. holiness and nation building, love and nation building, justice and nation building).

CRS 002: NEW TESTAMENT STUDIES: THE GOSPELS

Specific Objectives

At the end of this course, candidates should be able to:

1. give the synopsis of the New Testament literature, and highlight the New Testament background (i.e. an overview of the socio-political and religious institutions, such as the Maccabees, Sanhedrin, Pharisees and Temple);
2. clarify the term 'Synoptic', state why the Gospels are so called, examine the Synoptic Problem and proffer solution;

3. give a comprehensive exposition of the modern criticism of the Synoptics and clearly identify the aims of the critics;
4. discuss the Literature and Theology of the Synoptic Gospels; and
5. compare and contrast the Synoptic Gospels with the Gospel of John.

Course Content

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
1	Historical Background to the New Testament	An Overview of the Socio-Political Background of Israel	i) Trace the development of the nation of Israel under the Roman Empire. ii) The Revolt (Maccabean Revolt) iii) Socio-political groups: Zealot, Herodian etc.
		Religious Background	i) Identify the religious groups and institutions such as the Pharisees, Sadducees etc ii) Religious Institutions: Temple, Synagogue etc.
2	The Synopsis, Materials and the Canonization of the New Testament	The Synopsis and the Materials	i) Identify factors that delayed the writing of the Gospels such as persecution, Parousia, the availability of eye-witnesses etc. ii) Factors that prompted the writing of the Gospels: death of the eye witnesses; liturgical need; etc. iii) Highlight the sources of the materials of the Gospel writers: oral and written traditions.
		Canonization of the New Testament	i) Meaning of 'canonization'. ii) Discuss the process of canonization of the New Testament.
3	The Synoptic Gospels and the Synoptic Problem	The Synoptic Gospels	i) Meaning of 'Synoptic': <i>sun – opsis</i> (to view from the same angle). ii) Mention the Synoptic Gospels: Matthew, Mark and Luke
		The Synoptic Problem	i) Identify the similarities and dis-similarities of the synoptic gospels. ii) Proposed solutions to the Synoptic problem. iii) Appraise each of the solutions e.g Memorabilia; the Documentary Hypotheses; etc.
4	Modern Criticism of the Gospels	Various Criticisms of the Gospels	i) Discuss each of the modern criticisms of the gospels: Textual Criticism, Form Criticism, Source Criticism and Redaction Criticism ii) Evaluate the effects of each criticism on the Gospels
5	Literature and Theology of the Synoptic Gospels	Literature and Theology of Matthew	i) Discuss the authorship: Argument for and against Matthew and the destination. ii) Date of composition of the gospel iii) Purpose of the gospel.

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
			iv) Highlight the theological emphases of the gospel such as Messianic concept; Son of David; Kingdom of heaven; etc. v) Examine the characteristics of Saint Matthew's gospel: didactic, Gospel of fulfilment, Jewish emphasis etc.
		Literature and Theology of Mark	i) Authorship, purpose, date and destination of Mark's Gospel ii) Examine the characteristics of Saint Mark's Gospel: Action; Vividness; Candour; etc. iii) Highlight the theological emphases of the Gospel: Messianic Secrecy; Son of Man; etc.
		Literature and Theology of Luke	i) Authorship: arguments for and against Luke. ii) Date of composition of the Gospel. iii) Purpose of the composition of the Gospel. iv) The destination of the Gospel. v) Examine the characteristics of Saint Luke's Gospel such as Comprehensiveness; Universalism; prominence to women/children; etc. vi) The theological emphasis of Luke's gospel: Son of Man, Fatherhood of God etc.
6	The Synoptics and John's Gospel	The Gospel of Saint John	i) Authorship, Date and Purpose of the Gospel of John. ii) Comparison of John with the Synoptics: common themes; events; etc. iii) Contrast John's Gospel with the Synoptics.

CRS 003: HISTORY OF CHRISTIANITY IN WEST AFRICA

Specific Objectives

At the end of the course, candidates should be able to:

1. give an over-view of previous attempts at Christianizing Africa (North Africa and the efforts of the Portuguese in West Africa);
2. narrate the establishment of Christianity in Sierra Leone with emphasis on specific role of concerned groups like the Abolitionists; individuals and the ex-slaves;
3. discuss how Christianity was introduced to Ghana and Nigeria;
4. highlight the influence of Christianity on the various parts of Nigeria, and discuss the rise, characteristics and expansion of the African Independent Churches; and

5. examine Pentecostalism and the rise of New Religious Movements within the Church in Nigeria; and give a critical assessment of the causes, and impacts of proliferation of churches in Nigeria.

Course Content

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
1	An Over-view of Previous Attempts at Christianizing Africa	First Attempt - North Africa	i) Narrate Pre-Christian contacts with Africa: Abraham, Joseph, etc. were in Egypt, Africa (Gen. 12:10; 39-50). ii) Discuss Christian contacts with Africa: Baby Jesus; Pentecost Day; Ethiopian Eunuch; etc. (Matt. 2:13-15; Acts. 2; 8:26-40). iii) Reasons for the failure of planting Christianity during the first attempt: Heretical teachings/disunity; migration; Islamization; etc.
		The Second Attempt – the Portuguese Efforts	i) Narrate how Prince Henry of Portugal sponsored numerous expeditions to Africa from 1418 to 1460. ii) Evaluate the reasons for the explorations of Africa: Evangelical; commercial; etc. iii) State the reasons for their failure of planting Christianity: slavery/slave trade; climate; paucity of funds; etc.
2	Establishment of Christianity in Sierra Leone	The Evangelical Revivals in Europe and America	i) Effects of the evangelical revivals: Birth of Mission Societies - BMS, CMS, LMS; Emphasis on faith, zeal and philanthropy; etc. ii) List and explain the Anti-Slavery movements: The Abolitionists; Role of the Freed Slaves; etc.
		The Founding of Sierra Leone and the Planting of Christianity.	i) Give reasons for founding Sierra Leone: Economic; Social; Religious; etc. ii) Critical analyse the activities of Missionary groups: RCM; Baptist; Anglican; Presbyterian; Sudan Interior/United Missions; Christian Reformed Church; etc. iii) What are the successes and failures of the 1841, 1845 and 1857 Niger expeditions.
3	The Planting of Christianity in the Gold Coast (Ghana)	Missionary Efforts in the Gold Coast (Ghana)	i) Discuss the activities of the groups in Ghana: RCM; Presbyterian; Methodist; Anglican; etc.

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			ii) Enumerate the influence in the area of these groups; Western education; Agriculture; etc.
4	The Planting of Christianity in Nigeria	Missionary Activities in Yoruba Land	i) Narrate how Christianity was introduced in Abeokuta, Ibadan, Lagos, etc. ii) What are the influences of missionary activities e.g. CMS; RCM; WMS; Baptist; etc.
		Missionary activities in Igbo Land	i) Appraise the introduction of Christianity in Onitsha, Aba, etc. ii) Assess the influence of the missionary activities of the CMS; RCM- Holy Ghost Fathers; Methodist; etc.
		Missionary Activities in Northern Nigeria.	i) Discuss the introduction of Christianity in Lokoja, Zaria, Benue, etc. ii) Analyze the influence of the missionary activities of the CMS; RCM; SUM; SIM; etc.
		Missionary Activities in Calabar and Bonny Areas.	i) Appraise the introduction of Christianity in Calabar, Uyo, Oron, Bonny, and other parts of Nigeria through the efforts of the missionaries. ii) State the influence of the missionary activities of the CMS, Presbyterian, Methodist, Qua Iboe Mission QIM, etc.
5	The Rise of the African Independent Churches (AICs)	Clarification and Classification of the African Independent Churches (AICs)	i) Clarification of African Independent/Indigenous/Initiated Churches (AICs). ii) Classification of the AICs. iii) Distinguish the AICs from the Mainline and Pentecostal Churches. iv) Characteristics of the AICs: White garment; use of prayer aids; emphases on spirituality; proliferation; etc. v) Some founder/leaders: Garrick S. Braide; Moses Orimolade; S.B.J. Oschoffa; etc.
6	Pentecostalism in Nigeria	History and Development of Pentecostal Churches in Nigeria	i) Define Pentecostalism ii) Names some features of Pentecostalism: women ordination; media evangelism; prosperity gospel; etc. iii) Some Founders/Leaders: Bishop Benson Idahosa; W. F. Kumuyi; Apostle Numbere, etc. iii) Mention some of the founders/leaders of the Pentecostal churches in Nigeria e.g Bishop Benson Idahosa; W. F. Kumuyi; Apostle Numbere, etc.

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
7	Proliferation of Churches in Nigeria	Clarification of Term and Causes of Proliferation	i) Clarify the term 'Proliferation' ii) Enumerate the causes of Proliferation of Churches: Leadership tussle such as unemployment; doctrinal disagreements; etc.
		Impacts of Proliferation of Churches	i) State the merits of Proliferation of Churches: Expansion of the Church; employment generation; etc. ii) Evaluate the impact of Proliferation of Churches: Unhealthy rivalry; heresy; abuses; etc.

CRS 004: RELIGION AND SOCIETY

Specific Objectives

At the end of this course, candidates should be able to:

1. clarify the terms 'religion' and 'society' and discuss how they relate;
2. list and appraise the various theories of religion;
3. discuss how religiosity is measured;
4. state the place of religion in the society; and
5. examine what should be Christian response to contemporary issues.

Course Content

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
1	Relationship between Religion and Society	Meaning of Religion and Society	i) Define the terms 'Religion' and 'Society' ii) Critically assess the dimensions of 'Christian' religion: material/symbols, rituals, experience, ethics, myths, doctrine, and socials/institutions
		Relationship between Religion and Society.	i) Discuss how Religion and Society relate.
2	Theories of Religion	Conflict Theory: Karl Marx	i) Meaning, Background, Contextual basis of the theory ii) Evaluate the significance of the theory on Nigerian society
		Functional Theory: Emile Durkheim	i) Meaning, Background, Contextual basis of the theory ii) Evaluate the significance of the theory on Nigerian society

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
		Social Change Theory: Max Webber	i) Meaning, Background, Contextual basis of the theory ii) Evaluate the significance of the theory on Nigerian society
		Psycho-analytical Theory: Sigmund Freud	i) Meaning, Background, Contextual basis of the theory ii) Evaluate the significance of the theory on Nigerian society
		Phenomenological Theory: Fredrick Schleirmercher	i) Meaning, Background, Contextual basis of the theory ii) Evaluate the significance of the theory on Nigerian society
		Social Theory: Immanuel Kant	i) Meaning, Background, Contextual basis of the theory ii) Evaluate the significance of the theory on Nigerian society
3	Measures of Religiosity	Clarification of Terms	Clarify the terms ‘measure of religiosity’
		Criteria for Measuring Religiosity	Identify the criteria for measuring religiosity: Prayer; Church attendance; financial responsibility; use of religious language; etc.
4	Functions of religion	General Functions	i) Functions of religion in the society: maintenance of law and order; social cohesion; social control; etc. ii) Distinguish between positive and negative functions of religion
5	Religion, Peace and Conflict Resolution	Religion and Peace in the Society	i) religion and peace in the society ii) How religion can enhance peace in the society: inter-religious dialogue; tolerance; inter/intra-religious activities; etc.
		Religion and Conflict Resolution	Relate how religion can be used as a tool for conflict resolution: Dialogue; Forgiveness, Teaching/Preaching, Tolerance, Patience, Contentment, Counselling, Reconciliation; etc.
6	Religious Personality and Human Values	Religious Personality	Clarify the term ‘Religious Personality’
		Human Values	Identify of some human values: love, peace, benevolence, respect, responsibility, contentment, loyalty, hard work, honesty, power, dignity, perseverance, self-control, candour, security etc.

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
		Relating Religious Personality to Human values	State how religious personality can promote human values such as religious codes; sermons/teachings; promotion, reward motive; etc.
7	Christian Response to Contemporary Issues	Christianity and Contemporary issues in the Nigerian Society.	Mention some contemporary Issues such as Drug Abuse, Cultism, Corruption, Insurgencies, Rape, Abortion, Euthanasia, Examination Malpractices, Epidemic Diseases (e.g. Covid 19, HIV/AIDS), Bad Governance, Fundamentalism, Protest, Ritual Killings, Syncretism, Banditry, Gambling, Kidnapping, Fraud/Cyber Crime, Exploitation, Homosexuality/L, Human Trafficking, Electoral Violence, and Gender Based Violence

Recommended Text

1. Ayegboyin I.D. & Ishola S. A (2013) *African Indigenous Churches*. Bukuru: ACTS
2. Ayegboyin, I.D. (2004). *The Synoptics*. Ibadan: Daystar.
3. Baur, J. (2009). *2000 Years of Christianity in Africa*. 2nd edition. Nairobi: Paulines.
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5. Carvalho, C. L. {Ed.} (2014). *Anselm companion to the Bible: With NSRV translation*. Winona, Minnesota : Anselm Academic
6. Chenimuya, C. C. (2008). *Sociology of Religion*. Lagos: T-Excel Publishers.
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8. Douglas, J.D. *et al*, {Eds.} (1992). *New Bible Dictionary*. Leicester: IVP.
9. Espisto, J. L. *et al*, (2006). *World Religions Today*. Oxford: OUP.
10. Falk, P. (1997). *The Growth of the Church in Africa*. Jos: ACTS.
11. Folarin, O.G. (2004). *Studies in the Old Testament Prophecy*. 2nd Edition. Bukuru: ACTS.
12. Hindson, D. F. (2017). *History of Israel: Old Testament Introduction 1*. Revised Edition. Bukuru: ACTS.
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21. Obaje F.A. (2018). *Religion and Society*. (Vol. 2). Shomolu, Lagos: Distinct Prints
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23. Omojuwa A. I. (2014). *Christianity and Social Issues*. Lagos: Fetdee Publishers.
24. Omoyajowo, J. A. {Ed.} (1995). *Makers of the Church in Nigeria, 1842-1947*. Lagos: CSS
25. Oshitelu, G. A. (2002). *Expansion of Christianity in West Africa*. Abeokuta: Visual Resources Pub.
26. The Holy Bible (RSV).